

Hearing Loss Gold Standard – Venue Checklist

Use this checklist when visiting a venue. Mark each item Yes / Partly / No and add notes as needed.

A. Assistive listening (loop / telecoil / Auracast)

- ☐ Fixed hearing loop or assistive listening system at key contact points (reception, bar, counter, ticket desk).
- ☐ Loop or system covering main event / seating areas used for talks, performances or meetings.
- ☐ System meets recognised performance standards (e.g. IEC / BS 8300).
- ☐ Loop / system switched on and used whenever needed (not left off by default).

B. Maintenance and testing

- ☐ Professional service at least once every 12 months.
- ☐ Regular in-house checks with a loop listener / test device (e.g. weekly or before events).
- ☐ Clear process for reporting faults and getting them fixed promptly.
- ☐ Visitors are told when the loop is out of service and offered alternatives where possible.

C. Signage and information

- ☐ Clear hearing loop / T signage wherever a loop or system is available.
- ☐ Staff can explain simply how to use the system and where coverage is.
- ☐ Website / social media mention hearing loop / assistive listening and where it is available.
- ☐ Event listings state whether event spaces are looped and what other hearing support is provided.

D. Staff awareness (PACE)

- ☐ Key staff have basic deaf-awareness / hearing loss training.
- ☐ Staff use PACE – Patience, Attention, Clarity, Ear contact – when communicating with HoH people.
- ☐ Staff know how and when to reduce background noise for important conversations.
- ☐ Staff know who to contact if hearing systems or microphones are not working.

E. Environment (sound, light, layout)

- ☐ Lighting allows visitors to see faces clearly (no heavy back-lighting on speakers or staff).
- ☐ Conversation areas have reasonably controlled background noise.
- ☐ In events, microphones are used correctly and one person speaks at a time over the PA/loop.
- ☐ Seating layouts include good sightlines and strong loop coverage areas for HoH visitors.

F. Accessible information & booking

- ☐ Menus, notices and key information are available in clear, readable text with good contrast.
- ☐ Booking and contact options do not rely only on phone calls (online / email options available).
- ☐ Visitors are told how to request communication support (loop, captions, interpreters, written notes).

G. Policy, feedback and improvement

- ☐ Hearing access recognised as part of Equality Act 'reasonable adjustments'.
- ☐ Simple ways for HoH visitors to give feedback (online form, email, comments).
- ☐ Feedback leads to visible changes – fixing loops, improving signage, staff practice or layout.

Notes

Venue:

Date:

Visited by: